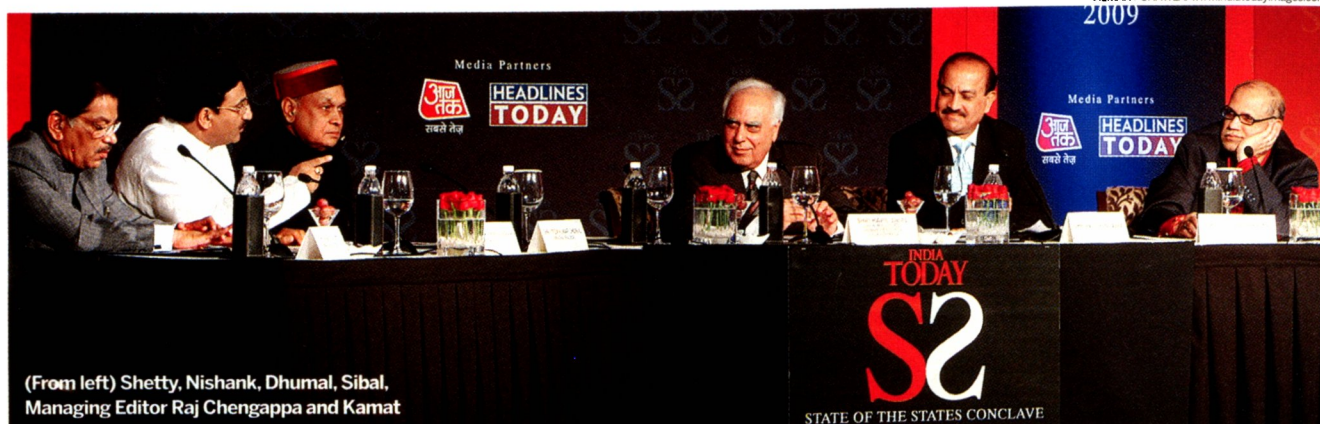




(From left) Shetty, Nishank, Dhumal, Sibal, Managing Editor Raj Chengappa and Kamat

vate sector to participate big time, both in schools as well as in higher education. In that context, I hope that the Cabinet will give approval to the entry of foreign universities into this country. In the ultimate analysis, in the education sector the keyword is choice. But it should not be the choice of the Central or the state governments, but the choice of the student. If you expand his choice, you would have delivered an excellent educational system for the people of this country.

I call upon the state governments, call upon the chief ministers, to find out how we should move together. This is not an equation where there should be any conflict. We have to seize this opportunity. This will not come again to us. We are the youngest nation in the world. We will be the suppliers of quality human resource not just for India but for the rest of the world. With the demographic decline in Europe and other parts of the world and the demographic dividend here, where will the human resource come from? It has to be from India. So, it will be our children who will grow up and provide that human resource for jobs, not just in India, but in other parts of the world as well. With an expanding economy, we need to change and expand our minds and also expand the way we think.

I don't want to raise a controversy but I will close with an issue. I look at it from the point of view of a child. For example, take a student who studies in Punjab or Tamil Nadu or, for that matter, in West Bengal. Under the Right to Education Act, he must as far as possible be taught in his mother tongue and I think that is absolutely necessary because the mother tongue integrates the child to his culture and also to his roots. When he passes Class VIII and

PREM KUMAR DHUMAL

Chief Minister, Himachal Pradesh

There is no doubt that a Centre-state co-ordinated effort with public-private partnership will be significant, especially in infrastructure building. If the business sector could contribute through corporate social responsibility, it will make a big difference. My humble request is that in such efforts, a consensus should be built from the ground level, not from above. In a federal system, considering Centre-state relationships, discussions should start at the ground level. You cannot just take a decision at the top and try and weave a consensus around it. The minister has spoken about assistance. Money is the sixth sense without which the other five cannot work. You can have ideas and programmes but we must first put together the resources.

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